



taxfix

What was your job status
in Germany in 2023?



Employed

☐ Minijob (up to €520 per month)

☐ Student

☐ Trainee

☐ On parental leave

☐ Unemployed

Case Study

The context

Taxfix Germany Expert Service connects people with qualified tax advisors who handle their tax return end-to-end. The consumer's job is to get started, share the right information, and respond to their advisor's follow-ups so the return is accurate and filed on time. The advisor's job is to file an accurate return. The product sits between two sides and has to work for both: simple, transparent, and trustworthy for the consumer, and efficient for the advisor who files the return. Getting that two-sided relationship right — **on a native mobile app** — is the job.

Who you're designing for

Target user profile: An expat in their 30s living in Germany, using the English-language interface. They've recently transitioned back to employment after a short gap and are facing their first mandatory German tax filing because they received unemployment benefits. They are navigating a foreign system with high stakes. Filing the return doesn't mean doing the tax work themselves; they'd rather an expert handle it than risk getting it wrong alone, so they choose an assisted service.

The challenge

This half, the **Expert Service** team is focused on growth, getting more of the right people into the product and converting them at the moments that matter. First-time filers are the hardest to convert: anxious, unsure they even need to file, skeptical of a service they've never used, and often arriving close to the **31 July** deadline.

Pick one real drop-off in that first-time journey and design to improve it. For example:

- **The "do I even need to file?" moment** — someone is unsure whether they're liable; help them find out and see why an assisted service is the safe way to handle it.
- **The commitment moment** — making it clear who handles the return, how it works, and what it costs, so they'll actually start.
- **The hand-off moment** — once they've signed up, getting them to share the information the advisor needs so the return can move (a common activation drop-off).

Pick the slice you find most interesting and design it well — focus beats breadth. You don't need to cover the full journey. **Design for a native mobile app.**

What to deliver

- **Problem framing** — the slice you chose and why, and what you deliberately decided not to design.
- **Your solution** — the key screens or flows that illustrate it.
- **AI in your process** — where it accelerated your work, and where your judgment had to correct it.
- **Validation** — how you'd validate this before launching.
- **Success criteria** — if it shipped, how you'd know it was working.
- **What to hand in** — something we can move through: a working prototype (built with AI tools, code, or a no-code tool) or a clickable Figma prototype. We'll build on it live in the panel, so the closer it is to something you can edit directly, the better.

Time and format

- **Aim for ~4 hours of work.** You have up to 5 days to submit (this covers a weekend); earlier is welcome. We mean the 4 hours — we're not looking for a polished production spec.
- **The panel is 1h15:** ~15 minutes presenting your case study, ~30 minutes live working session (see below), ~30 minutes, intros, Q&A and discussion. Be succinct in the presentation — we cover more in the Q&A. Bring your working files and AI tools open and ready before the session

Tools

Use whatever gets you there — Claude Code, Cursor, v0, Bolt, Lovable, Figma, code, or a combination. The output method is irrelevant; the quality of the result is everything. We do expect to see AI in your process, directed by your taste and judgment, not used as a shortcut. If AI generated something you then refined or rejected, that's worth talking about.

How we assess it

- User & problem understanding — who did you design for, and what did that mean for the decisions you made?
- Solution quality & interaction design — **native mobile app** execution, clarity, trust signals.
- AI as a force multiplier — did AI accelerate the work, and did you know when to override it?
- Craft judgment — does the result feel trustworthy and considered, not just generated?
- Marketplace thinking — does the design serve the consumer↔advisor relationship, not just the consumer alone?
- Business outcomes — what does success look like for this, and how would you know?

We're looking for reasoning from the user's problem, not a template.

What we don't expect

Not a complete product or every edge case. Pick a few meaningful moments and execute them well. The same goes for validation and success metrics — we want to see how you think, not a finished plan. Work with assumptions freely, but name them so we can follow your thinking.

The live session — what to prepare

Time: 30 minutes. 20 minutes to build, 10 minutes of discussion.

Right after your presentation, we'll hand you a new constraint on the spot — a shifted user context, a business requirement that changes the calculus, or an edge case your solution didn't account for. You'll have 20 minutes to adapt what you've already built to handle it: scoping out loud first, then building. The output should be tangible — a working screen, a built prototype, or a deployed snippet — not a Figma edit. Then we'll spend 10 minutes discussing what you built, what you chose not to build, and why.

We're not looking for a polished result. We're watching how you move: how quickly you orient, what you reach for first, and whether AI is doing real work in the build or sitting on the sidelines.

How to prepare: Come with your laptop, your AI tools open, and your working files loaded before the session starts. We'll begin immediately; there's no setup time. Use whatever tools and stack you're most productive with; there are no restrictions.

Be ready to narrate as you go. Thinking out loud — including the moments where you decide to change direction — is part of what we're assessing.

What we'll be watching for:

- Do you reach for AI tools immediately, or do you default to manual work?
- Can you scope down to something buildable within the first couple of minutes, or do you try to cover everything?
- When AI output is close but wrong, do you catch it and fix it — or ship it anyway?
- Does the thing you build reflect a real design decision, or is it just the path of least resistance?

There's no single right answer to what you build. What matters is the quality of the judgment behind it.

Reach out with any questions. Good luck! 🍀

